

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, less humid, sunshine returning, high 82. **Tonight**, partly cloudy, low 71. **Tomorrow**, some sun, afternoon thunderstorm, more humid, high 84. Weather map, Page B12.

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WEDNESDAY, JULY 8, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00

City High-Rise Seen Buckling During Project

Officials Seal Off Area
Near Grand Central

By ASHLEY SOUTHALL
and MIHIR ZAVERI

Twenty-one stories above a Midtown Manhattan street early Tuesday morning, construction workers were busy converting an office building into a residential complex when it began falling apart.

“The beams started bending,” said Cliff Johnsen, the business agent for the Local 638 steamfitters union, which had workers on site. Several floors were sagging.

The building seemed to be crumbling fast, he said.

The workers evacuated the building, at 235 East 42nd Street, near Grand Central Terminal and the United Nations, and a supervisor called 911, prompting a hurried emergency response. Fearing a partial collapse, officials evacuated nearby buildings and blocked off several nearby streets to pedestrians and vehicular traffic.

Officials said there were no injuries, but they had seen severe structural damage between the 21st and 26th floors. The building was still standing, but it remained unstable, they said. Dozens of businesses were displaced and tourists were stranded indefinitely after the city established a “frozen zone” spanning several blocks. The cause of the incident is under investigation.

The episode stalled a project that had come to symbolize the city’s ambitious effort to repurpose Midtown’s empty office buildings to address the city’s housing shortage. Developers called the project the largest office-to-residential conversion in city history; it had been set for completion next year.

The dramatic episode on Tuesday, though, clouded the project’s future, as inspectors raced to figure out what exactly went wrong, how it could be fixed and the full extent of the problems.

At a news conference in the early afternoon, Mayor Zohran Mamdani said that building inspectors using drones to survey the 37-story building spotted two columns that had buckled, several cracks and sagging floors. The building continued to shift after the authorities arrived, he said.

“The building remains unstable,” he said, urging people to avoid the area until the authorities deemed it safe.

MetroLoft, the developer on the apartment conversion, thanked city officials for their quick response and said in a statement that the damage was limited to a small area of the building. “The entire building itself is not at risk of collapse,” the company said.

The Fire Department shared photos from the building on social media that showed missing paneling on the building facade and a vertical beam bent like an elbow. Fire officials said there was no risk of a full building collapse because of its steel-frame construction.

The Fire Department said it responded to a call at 8 a.m. on Monday from someone reporting bricks falling off the building.

Continued on Page A17



DAVE SANDERS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Pieces of a Midtown Manhattan office building began to crack and crumble as work was being done to convert the space to housing.

NEWS ANALYSIS

Europe’s Test: Filling U.S.-Size Hole at NATO

By STEVEN ERLANGER
and LARA JAKES

ANKARA, Turkey — European leaders arrive for this year’s NATO summit meeting in Ankara, Turkey, with the alliance under threat.

They want to keep President Trump and the United States deeply engaged in NATO, but they have come to accept that the alliance is changing — and will have to rely far less on Washington for the conventional defense of Europe.

The Trump administration has made it clear that it is withdrawing troops and capabilities from Europe to shore up American military power in the Middle

East and the Indo-Pacific, where China has become a rival to the United States.

The European governments want to ensure that the transition toward what many call NATO 3.0 is done as smoothly as possible. They want to feel confident that the gaps the Americans leave can be filled, even if imperfectly, to diminish their vulnerability to a more aggressive, militarized Russia.

The dangers of the current moment have been underscored by China’s test of a long-range ballistic missile on Monday, the first such launch in nearly two years, and another huge Russian missile and drone attack on Kyiv, Ukraine’s capital.

NATO leaders are expected to

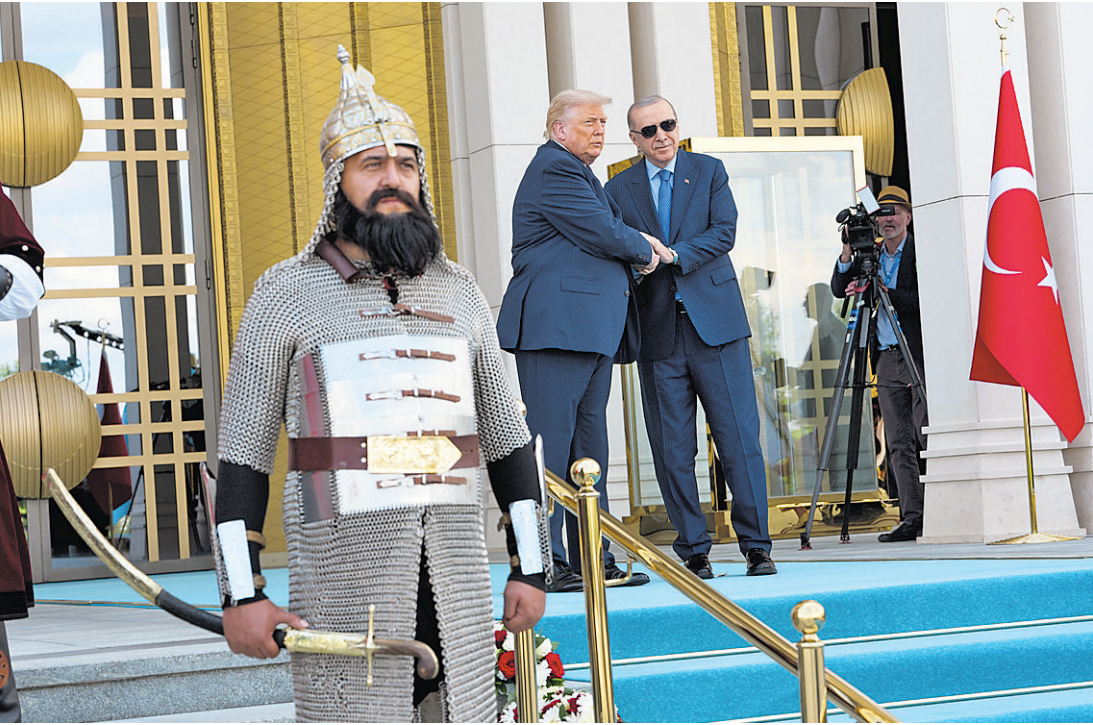
endorse continued support for Ukraine, with the non-American members pledging \$80 billion this year and next. President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine will attend, to press his urgent desire for more air defenses against the Russian onslaught.

Mark Rutte, the secretary general of NATO, is trying to walk a narrow line, prodding European member states to pay more for security while making sure Mr. Trump does not abandon the alliance in the process.

“We will breathe life into the concept of NATO 3.0: A stronger Europe in a stronger NATO,” he said last month.

But for several years at least,

Continued on Page A9



DOUG MILLS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Presidents Trump and Recep Tayyip Erdogan and an honor guard in Ankara, Turkey, NATO’s host.

Olympics Lifts Russian Ban, With Limits

By EPHRAT LIVNI

The International Olympic Committee on Tuesday lifted its suspension of Russia related to its invasion of Ukraine, clearing the way for Russia to send a team to the 2028 Summer Olympics in Los Angeles.

The Olympic Committee said its decision applied “provisionally,” subject to Russian conduct in the future, and that it had not yet decided whether it would allow the Russian flag or anthem at the games.

Still, it was a significant step for bringing Russian athletes, who have struggled with their country’s pariah status on the world stage, back into the international fold after several years.

Debate over lifting the suspension centered on the Russian Olympic Committee’s claims that parts of Ukraine were under its jurisdiction.

In a statement, the I.O.C. executive board said that after “thorough analysis” by legal experts, it accepted that the Russian committee no longer considered regional sports organizations in Ukrainian territory as its own, and would abstain from doing so in the future.

When the suspension was announced in 2023, Russia questioned why the international committee had not taken similar actions after Russia seized Crimea from Ukraine in 2014, according to the international organization’s president at the time, Thomas Bach.

“This argument was a little bit, ‘Why did you not sanction us already, earlier?’” Mr. Bach said, ar-

Continued on Page A5

Trump Tries to Rewrite History at Smithsonian

By MAGGIE HABERMAN
and JONATHAN SWAN

Coming from the leader of almost any other major museum, the comments made around the celebration of America’s 250th anniversary by Lonnie G. Bunch III, the head of the Smithsonian Institution, would have seemed almost self-evident truths.

The Smithsonian’s mission, Mr. Bunch told CNN last week, is to

Effort to Impose Views on National Record

“give you questions and answers that will make you understand the complexity of who we are as a nation” using “the best nonpartisan scholarship we have.” On NBC’s “Meet the Press,” he said the institution was like the glue that holds

the nation together. “Red states, blue states — whatever your politics, you come to the Smithsonian,” he said.

But after more than a year of intense pressure from President Trump and his allies over what they term “improper ideology” in the Smithsonian’s presentation of American history and culture, Mr. Bunch’s comments amounted to a public glimpse into a far less diplomatic

Continued on Page A12

Loss for U.S. Soccer, but Leap by Soccer in U.S.

By DAVID WALDSTEIN

As the United States players hung their heads after a 4-1 loss to Belgium in Seattle on Monday night, a nation momentarily captivated by soccer mourned the sudden end of a promising journey.

But buried within the disappointment of the sobering defeat was evidence that this World Cup had accelerated soccer’s decades-long climb into the na-

Devotion to Cultivating Youth and Pro Talent

tional consciousness.

With established professional leagues for both men and women, and youth participation continuing to soar, the men’s national team is far from the sole metric for the health of the sport in the

United States. Despite the end of the U.S.’s World Cup run, soccer’s stakeholders are eagerly anticipating a boost for the sport’s presence and potential in a nation where it has long battled other sports for attention.

Continued on Page A14

REALITY CHECK An American dream fizzled at the World Cup in an all-too-familiar way. PAGE B6



INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Le Pen to Run Again in France

Marine Le Pen’s conviction was confirmed, but a ban on her eligibility for elected office was shortened. PAGE A7

Farage Prompts By-Election

The leader of Britain’s Reform U.K. Party has been questioned about undisclosed gifts and donations. PAGE A5

NATIONAL A10-17

Antismoking Efforts Falter

The C.D.C.’s tobacco control office has been shuttered for more than a year. And calls to 1-800-QUIT-NOW lines have plummeted. PAGE A13

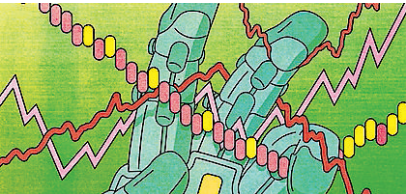
Politics and Climate Change

Bill Frist, a former Senate majority leader, has emerged as an advocate for environmental health. PAGE A16

SPORTS B6-9, 12

An Insider’s View of Tennis

Sandra Zaniewska, who coaches Marta Kostyuk of Ukraine, applies a writerly touch to her newsletter. PAGE B8



BUSINESS B1-5

A.I.’s Cryptic Economic Effect

Some data suggests artificial intelligence is causing job losses. Others, however, show the opposite. PAGE B1

Businesses Brace for Fallout

A Supreme Court ruling that gives the president more power over U.S. agencies has industries concerned. PAGE B1

ARTS C1-6

Britain’s Lost Music Venues

A new museum exhibition in London charts the cyclical forces destroying nightlife spots, as clubs battle building developers, complaining neighbors and shifting social habits. PAGE C1

An Onstage Promotion

After his sparkling debut as Basilio in “Don Quixote,” Jake Roxander was elevated to principal dancer at the American Ballet Theater. He discusses his reaction to the news. PAGE C1

OPINION A18-19

Michelle Goldberg

PAGE A18



FOOD D1-8

They’re Always in Season

In just the past decade, berries have been transformed from a fragile, local treat to a worldwide refrigerator staple and marketing juggernaut. PAGE D8



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